Heilman Auto Group

Ardmore · West Chester · Hatboro, PA · Est. 1986

THE REASON WHY
ONE JUSTIFICATION PER MOVE

These build on the reputation Jack and the team have spent nearly four decades earning. None of them change what works — they carry that hard-won trust forward into how the shops price, book, and protect their work. Each move, with the one reason it earns its place.

1 Raise the labor rate — $139 → $169/hr

~100% margin · +$432K/yr

The shops' rates have held steady for years while the market around them kept climbing. Comparable independent shops across the affluent Main Line and Chester County corridor now sit higher, and a brand-new shop nearby opened at $170. A rate increase is the **one lever that adds almost no cost** — no extra parts, labor, or bay time — and nearly four decades of earned trust more than support it.

BOTTOM LINE
Newer shops already charge $170. Heilman's reputation has earned the right to at least match the market.

2 Roll fluids into a Shop Supplies Fee — 7% of labor, capped $40

No upfront cost · +$140K/yr · live this week

Itemizing small consumables like washer fluid or a half-quart of oil recovers pennies, but it can rub a loyal customer the wrong way. Rolling them into a single **capped shop-supplies fee** recovers the same cost quietly across the ticket — and frees the team to keep giving away the small stuff that builds goodwill, the goodwill that brings the $1,500 jobs back.

BOTTOM LINE
A small structural fee protects the margin and the relationship at the same time.

3 Add a shop-management system across all 3 shops

~$1,500/mo (est.) · pays for itself by the 9th · $3.61 back per $1

The shops have run on paper and built a loyal following doing it — but across three locations, paper makes it easy to lose the last 0.2 hours of diag or cleanup, and it can't timestamp a digital authorization. A system like Tekmetric captures that work automatically, ends the phone-vs-online double-bookings that leave bays idle, and turns every authorization into a clean, PA-compliant record. The recovered time alone covers the cost in the **first week and a half of each month**.

BOTTOM LINE
Paper got the shops this far. A system is what lets them grow without losing the details.

4 Reprice diagnostics to 1.0 hr of the new rate — paired with Video MPI

$100 → $160+ · higher close rate on the repair that follows

Diagnostics use the most expensive tools and the most skilled hands in the building. Pricing a full diagnosis at a fair hour of labor simply matches the fee to the skill it takes to trace a CAN-bus fault or EVAP leak. Pairing it with a **video multi-point inspection — built right into Tekmetric's DVI** — makes that fee easy to understand: the tech records the fault and sends it to the customer's phone, and when they see the problem on screen, they approve the repair with confidence.

BOTTOM LINE
Price the expertise fairly, and let the video do the explaining.

5 Upgrade the digital front door — and it's already built

Redesign mockup done · platform wiring next

The current site has served the shops well, but it can't take a digital authorization or deliver the video that lifts the average repair order. So the next version is **already built and ready to show** — a redesign that keeps Heilman's original logo and red-white-blue branding, leads with the 1986 honesty story, puts the real shop photos and customer reviews front and center, and books an appointment in two taps (pick location, pick service). The next step is connecting it to a scheduling platform so every booking becomes a signed, timestamped, PA-compliant record instead of a phone-tag callback.

BOTTOM LINE
The new front door is built on the brand you've always had. Approve the platform and it goes live.